



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- 2.b) Menarche and menopause are not only biological events but also cultural constructs.
Examine. (15 Marks)

Menarche is the age of ^{starting} cessation of endometrium and onset of the period or menstrual cycle in the women.

Menopause is the complete cessation of period or menstrual cycle in the women, usually it takes 12 months from last period.

Menarche as a Biological event

1) There is pre-programmed gene that will start the onset of the Menarche in women.

2) These gene will express itself on being getting better nutrition body fat of 17%

3) It tells that womb of the women is ready for the Conceiving.

Menarche as a Cultural Construct

① Rites of Passage :→ Cultural belief of various society, where women is transitioning from childhood to motherhood

(eg) In Ndembu Society :→ Under Mudyi tree, Nkanga ritual.

② Concept of temporary pollution :→ Louis Dumont said.

③ she is being worshipped earlier → Kanya Pujan in Navratri (pre-menarche)

Menopause as Biological event

① Women organ deteriorate after certain age, as the lifespan has increased. → There is attrition in the cell.

- ② women has limited number of eggs, which they are born, so they are over.
- ③ women, has to preserve the energy for her self-growth, so not to invest entirely on menstruation
↳ care for Grandchildren as well.

Menopause as Cultural event

- ① In Rajasthan, Marchia Flint studied that women got autonomy, liberty and empowered, post menopause.
- ② In USA, youth and blood oozing women is favoured, so menopause women are not liked much.
- ③ Menopausal phase is the one, where she is not given care ~~much~~ as she will not impact the survival of the group.

Thus, Menopause and menarche come with both biological & cultural events.